# Matthew C. Nowlin

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## Academic Appointments

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| Associate Professor of Political Science, University of Texas at Arlington | 2025-Present |
| Director of the Master of Public Administration program, College of Charleston | 2022-2025 |
| Associate Professor of Political Science, College of Charleston | 2019-2025 |
| Assistant Professor of Political Science, College of Charleston | 2013-2019 |
| Graduate Research Assistant, Center for Applied Social Research, University of Oklahoma | 2008-2013 |

## Academic Affiliations

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|---|---|
| Faculty Affiliate, Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis, University of Oklahoma | 2024-Present |
| Faculty Affiliate, Sustainability Literacy Institute, College of Charleston | 2017-2021 |
| Research Fellow, Center for Public Choice and Market Process, College of Charleston | 2014-2019 |

## Education

Ph.D., Political Science, University of Oklahoma 2013
Fields: Public Policy, Public Administration, American Politics
M.A., Political Science, University of Central Oklahoma 2008
Emphasis: Public Affairs
B.A., Psychology, University of Central Oklahoma 2003

## Publications

*Student collaborators underlined*

### Books

1. **Nowlin, Matthew C.**, and Bishoy Zaki. 2026. *Policy Learning and Information Processing Dynamics*. Cambridge Elements in Public Policy. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. *Forthcoming*
2. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2019. *Environmental Policymaking in an Era of Climate Change*. New York, NY: Routledge. DOI: https://doi.org/10.4324/9781315441726

### Journal Articles

1. Rabovsky, Tom, **Matthew C. Nowlin**, and Emily Mee. 2026. "Cultural Theory, Political Ideology, and Burden Tolerance: The Role of Core Beliefs in Shaping Support for Administrative Burdens."*American Review of Public Administration*, Forthcoming DOI: https://doi.org/10.1177/02750740261478906

2. Vantaggiato, Francesca, Mark Lubell, **Matthew C. Nowlin**, Juita-Elena (Wie) Yusuf, and Majid Shafiee-Jood. 2026. "Sea-Level Rise Adaptation and Collaboration in Polycentric Governance: A Comparison of Three Regions." *Public Administration Review*, Forthcoming DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/puar.70117

3. **Nowlin, Matthew C**. 2026. "What Beliefs Are Central in the Climate Change Belief System Network?" *Social Science Quarterly* 107(5): e70202. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/ssqu.70202

4. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** and Aaron C. Sparks. 2026. "Behaving Sustainably: Cultural Cognition, Environmental Orientation, and Pro-Environmental Behavior." *Sustainability*, 18(17). DOI: https://doi.org/10.3390/su18178883

5. **Nowlin, Matthew C.**, Chris Anderson, and Justin Reedy. 2026. "Deciding Who Decides: Trust and Support for Elected Official, Expert, and Citizen Decision-Making Regarding Nuclear Waste Management." *Review of Policy Research*, 43(1). DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/ropr.70008

6. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2024. "Policy Beliefs, Belief Uncertainty, and Policy Learning Through the Lens of the Advocacy Coalition Framework." *Policy and Politics* 52(4): 675-695 DOI: https://doi.org/10.1332/03055736Y2023D000000002

7. Cannon, Sean, Abigail Prochaska, Kendra Stewart, Timothy Callahan, and **Matthew Nowlin**. 2024. "Identifying Barriers Preventing Stormwater Pond Buffer Implementation in Coastal South Carolina." *Journal of South Carolina Water Resources* 9(2). DOI: https://doi.org/10.34068/jscwr.09.02.07

8. Reedy, Justin, Chris Anderson, and **Matthew C. Nowlin**. 2023. "Technical Issues and Engagement Processes: Support for Citizen and Expert Deliberation Regarding the Management of Nuclear Waste." *Frontiers in Communication*, 8. DOI: https://doi.org/10.3389/fcomm.2023.1237736

9. Wehde, Wesley and **Matthew C. Nowlin**. 2023. "Determining Patterns of Routine Weather Information Usage and Their Demographic Determinants." *Weather, Climate, and Society*, 15(3): 711-725. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1175/WCAS-D-22-0106.1

10. Rountree, John, Chris Anderson, Justin Reedy, and **Matthew C. Nowlin**. 2022. "The Internal Dynamics of 'Scaling Up' Deliberative Mini-Publics." *Communication and the Public*, 7(3): 146-164. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1177/20570473221106025

11. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2022. "Who Should 'Do More' about Climate Change? Cultural Theory, Polycentricity, and Public Support for Climate Change Actions across Actors and Governments." *Review of Policy Research*, 39(4): 468-485. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/ropr.12468

12. **Nowlin, Matthew C.**, Maren Trochmann, and Thomas Rabovsky. 2022. "Advocacy Coalitions and Political Control." *Politics and Policy*, 50(2): 201-224 DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/polp.12458

13. Hawes, Rachel and **Matthew C. Nowlin**. 2022. "Climate Science or Politics? Disentangling the Roles of Citizen Beliefs and Support for Energy in the United States." *Energy Research and Social Science*, 85. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.erss.2021.102419

14. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2021. "Policy Learning and Information Processing." *Policy Studies Journal*, 49(4): 1019-1039. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/psj.12397

15. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** and Wesley Wehde. 2021. "Social Capital and Hurricane Warning Response." *International Journal of Disaster Risk Reduction*, 65. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijdrr.2021.102536

16. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2021. "Political Beliefs, Views about Technocracy, and Energy and Climate Policy Preferences." *Public Understanding of Science*, 30(3): 331-348. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1177/0963662520978567

17. Wehde, Welsey and **Matthew C. Nowlin**. 2021. "Public Attribution of Responsibility for Disaster Preparedness across Three Levels of Government and the Public: Lessons from a Survey of Residents of the U.S. South Atlantic and Gulf Coast Areas." *Publius: The Journal of Federalism*, 51(2): 212-237. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/publius/pjaa037

18. Bundrick Jr., M. Lee, and **Matthew C. Nowlin**. 2020. "Place, Values, and Public Opinion About Climate Change in South Carolina." *Journal of Political Science*, 48(1): 85-109.

19. **Nowlin, Matthew C.**, Kuhika Gupta, and Joseph T. Ripberger. 2020. "Revenue Use and Public Support for a Carbon Tax." *Environmental Research Letters*, 15(8). DOI: https://doi.org/10.1088/1748-9326/ab92c3

20. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** and Thomas M. Rabovsky. 2020. "A Cultural Theory of Partisanship and Policy Attitudes." *Social Science Quarterly*, 101(2): 878-892. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/ssqu.12750

21. Gupta, Kuhika, **Matthew C. Nowlin**, Joseph T. Ripberger, Hank Jenkins-Smith, and Carol Silva. 2019. "Tracking the Nuclear 'Mood' in the United States: Introducing a Long-Term Measure of Public Opinion about Nuclear Energy Using Aggregate Survey Data." *Energy Policy*, 133. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.enpol.2019.110888

22. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** and Thaddieus W. Conner. 2019. " 'Hot Rocks that Shoot Ghost Bullets': Native American Perceptions of a Nuclear Waste Facility." *Politics, Groups, and Identities*, 7(1): 21-38. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1080/21565503.2017.1304222

23. Conner, Thaddieus W., **Matthew C. Nowlin**, Thomas M. Rabovsky, and Joseph T. Ripberger. 2016. "Cultural Theory and Managerial Values: Examining Trust as a Motivation for Collaboration." *Public Administration*, 94(4): 915-932. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/padm.12200

24. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2016. "Modeling Issue Definitions using Quantitative Text Analysis." *Policy Studies Journal*, 44(3): 309-331. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/psj.12110

25. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2016. "Policy Change, Policy Feedback, and Interest Mobilization: The Politics of Nuclear Waste Management." *Review of Policy Research*, 33(1): 51-70. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/ropr.12158

26. Ripberger, Joseph T., Geoboo Song, **Matthew C. Nowlin**, Michael D. Jones, and Hank C. Jenkins-Smith. 2012. "Reconsidering the Relationship Between Cultural Theory, Political Ideology, and Political Knowledge." *Social Science Quarterly*, 93(3): 713–731. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-6237.2012.00884.x

27. Goebbert, Kevin, Hank C. Jenkins-Smith, Kim Klockow, **Matthew C. Nowlin**, and Carol L. Silva. 2012. "Weather, Climate and Worldviews: The Sources and Consequences of Public Perceptions of Changes in Local Weather Patterns." *Weather, Climate, and Society*, 4(2): 132–144. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1175/WCAS-D-11-00044.1

28. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2011. "Theories of the Policy Process: State of the Research and Emerging Trends." *Policy Studies Journal*, 39(s1): 41–60. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1541-0072.2010.00389_4.x

    *Excerpted in*: Theodoulou, Stella Z., and Matthew A. Cahn (eds). 2013. *Public Policy: The Essential Readings*. 2nd Edition. Pearson: New York, NY. pgs. 190–195

29. Jenkins-Smith, Hank C., Carol L. Silva, Carol L., **Matthew C. Nowlin**, and Grant deLozier. 2011. "Reversing Nuclear Opposition: Evolving Public Acceptance of a Permanent Nuclear Waste Disposal Facility." *Risk Analysis*, 31(4): 629–644. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1539-6924.2010.01543.x

30. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2008. "The Implementation of the Oklahoma Marriage Initiative to Individuals Receiving Temporary Assistance for Needy Families." *Oklahoma Politics*, Vol. 18: 111-131.

## Book Chapters

1. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2026. "Beliefs Updating through Information Processing." In *Handbook of Policy Learning*, eds. Claudio M. Radaelli and Bishoy L. Zaki. Edward Elgar Publishing, 193-204. DOI (book): https://doi.org/10.4337/9781035349234

2. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2025. "Learning and Uncertainty: Information Environments and Policy-Oriented Learning." In *The Advocacy Coalition Framework*, eds. Hank Jenkins-Smith and Christopher Weible. Palgrave Macmillan, 155-182. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-031-85554-2_7
3. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** and Wesley Wehde. 2024. "Teaching Quantitative Methods to Students of Public Policy." In *Handbook of Teaching Public Policy*, eds. Philippe Zittoun & Emily St Denny. Edward Elgar Publishing, 168-80. DOI: https://doi.org/10.4337/9781800378117.00022

### Refereed Conference Proceedings

**Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2015. "Partisanship, Information, and Public Opinion about Yucca Mountain." In *Proceedings of the 15th International High-Level Radioactive Waste Management Conference*, 226-231. American Nuclear Society.

### Book Reviews

1. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2026. "The Other Public Lands: Preservation, Extraction, and Politics on the Fifty States' Natural Resource Lands. By Steven Davis. Philadelphia: Temple University Press, 2025. 260p." *Perspectives on Politics*, forthcoming DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537592726106136
2. **Nowlin, Matthew C.** 2018. "Improving Governance of Risk and Uncertainty." *Journal of Public Administration Research and Theory*, 28(1): 158-160. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/jopart/mux031

### Open-Source Educational Resources

1. Jenkins-Smith, Hank C., Joseph T. Ripberger, Gary Copeland, **Matthew C. Nowlin**, Tyler Hughes, Aaron L. Fister, and Wesley Wehde. 2017. *Quantitative Research Methods for Political Science, Public Policy, and Public Administration*. University Libraries, University of Oklahoma. SHAREOK, Open Education Resource. DOI: http://dx.doi.org/10.15763/11244/52244

## Research Funding

### Lead PI

1. *Stakeholder Collaboration in Climate Change Planning and Decision-Making Networks*, Center for Public Choice and Market Process, School of Business, College of Charleston, 2018–2019. $5,040.00.
2. *Risk, Resilience, and Environmental Justice*, Sustainability Literacy Institute at the College of Charleston, Summer 2018. $3,000.00.
3. *Public Support for a Carbon Tax to Address Climate Change*, Center for Public Choice and Market Process, School of Business, College of Charleston, 2017–2018. $7,000.00.
4. *Institutional Diversity in Dealing with Sea-Level Rise in South Carolina*, Sustainability Literacy Institute at the College of Charleston, Summer and Fall 2017. $2,000.00.
5. *The Political Economy of Climate Change Governance in the United States*, Center for Public Choice and Market Process, School of Business, College of Charleston, 2016–2017. $7,000.00.
6. *Understanding Perceptions of Climate Change in South Carolina's Coastal Communities: An Approach using Cultural Cognition and Deliberative Polling*, South Carolina Sea Grant Consortium, 2014–2015. $25,000.00.
7. *Congressional Hearings and the Collection of Information: Committee Chairs and the Politics of Climate Change*, Center for Public Choice and Market Process, School of Business, College of Charleston, 2014–2015. $7,000.00.
8. *Understanding Perceptions of Climate Change in Charleston: An Approach using Cultural Cognition and Deliberative Democracy*, with Lorna Parkinson, Student/Faculty Research Development Funding, Master of Environmental Studies Program, College of Charleston, 2014–2015. $2,500.00.

Co-PI

1. *Flipping the Cages on Sustainable Aquaculture: A Study on Oyster Aquaculture Technique and Policy to Reduce Pathogens*, Sustainable Agriculture Research & Education - US Department of Agriculture, 2023–2026, Co-PI with Sarah Pedigo (Lead PI), Matthew Gorstein, Peter Kingsley-Smith, and Mike Marshall. $361,000.00. https://projects.sare.org/sare_project/ls23-379/
2. *Studying How Things Fall Apart: Exploring Municipal Services System Failures to Help Develop Science-Based Decision-Points in South Carolina Coastal Communities*, Climate Program Office, Adaptation Sciences Program - National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA), Oceanic and Atmospheric Research (OAR), 2021–2023, Co-PI with Susan Lovelace (Lead PI), Kirstin Dow, Matthew Gorstein, Landon Knapp, Norm Levine, Robert Merchant, Abi Locatis Prochaska, Sarah Watson, and Alicia Wilson, $298,218.00.
3. *Can Deliberative Discussions Lay a Foundation for Integrated Decision-Making Networks*?, Gulf Research Program of the National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine, 2016–2018, Co-PI with Susan Lovelace and Justin Reedy, $259,414.00.

## Invited Talks

1. *Environmental Policymaking: Process and Evolution*, City University of New York, Environmental Policy-making graduate course. *Virtual*, February 2025.
2. *Environmental Policy, Politics, and Polarization*, Panel discussion, "Environmental Policy and the Impact of Elections," College of Charleston. Charleston, SC. October 2024.
3. *Institutions and Actors in US Climate Policy*, City University of New York, Environmental Policymaking graduate course. *Virtual*, April 2024.
4. *Beliefs about Climate Change*, Center for Coastal Physical Oceanography and Institute for Coastal Adaptation & Resilience, Old Dominion University, Fall 2023 Virtual Seminar Series. *Virtual*, September 2023.
5. *Deliberative Processes as a Tool for Stakeholder Engagement*, S.C. Sea Grant Consortium Research Symposium. Charleston, SC. May 2022
6. *Public Opinion About Climate Change in South Carolina*, Coastal and Environmental Law Summit. Charleston, SC. November 2019.
7. *Climate Change: Science, Policy, and Politics*, Science Cafe: Charleston County Public Library, Hurd/St. Andrews Branch. Charleston, SC. October 2019.
8. *Carbon Tax and Public Opinion*, Panel discussion "Climate Change: Is A Carbon Tax A Solution," College of Charleston. Charleston, SC. October 2019.
9. *The Policy and Politics of Climate Change*, Charleston County Democratic Women. Charleston, SC. November 2017.
10. *Understanding Climate Change*, Charleston County Public Library. Charleston, SC. August 2017.

## Academic and Professional Conferences

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| American Political Science Association | 2014, 2016, 2018-2019, 2023, 2026 |
| Carolinas Climate Resilience Conference | 2016 |
| Conference on Policy Process Research | 2023-2024 |
| International Workshops on Public Policy | 2022 |
| Midwest Political Science Association | 2009-2012, 2014-2019, 2021-2022, 2025-2026 |
| National Nuclear Fuel Cycle Summit | 2012 |
| Public Choice Society | 2014 |
| Social Coast Forum | 2018, 2020, 2024 |
| Used Fuel Management Conference | 2014 |

Western Political Science Association 2015, 2019, 2021